Nivolumab 3 mg/kg + ipilimumab 1 mg/kg — advanced melanoma

NCCP 00551 · Draft source reconciliation; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Practical treatment planning

Agree the arrangements with your oncology team.

STEP 1

Taking or receiving treatment

During combination treatment, nivolumab 3 mg/kg is infused first over 30 minutes, then ipilimumab 1 mg/kg over 30 minutes. Maintenance may be nivolumab IV 240 mg every two weeks or IV 480 mg every four weeks, or the prescribed subcutaneous alternative of 600 mg every two weeks or 1200 mg every four weeks. In this melanoma source, IV 240 mg takes 30 minutes and IV 480 mg takes 60 minutes; subcutaneous administration takes about three to five minutes.

STEP 2

Missed, vomited or held treatment

If a dose is delayed or held, obtain a revised written plan. The first two-weekly maintenance dose starts three weeks after the last combination dose; the first four-weekly dose starts six weeks afterwards. Do not calculate a different start from the maintenance interval alone. Earlier immune toxicity and permanent-stop decisions still apply.

STEP 3

Appointments and supply

Arrange blood tests, transport, medicine supply and interpreter or carer support. Check who reviews results and how you receive the decision before the next dose.

STEP 4

Paper copies and contacts

Keep the full handbook, three-page summary and wallet card together. The QR code is optional. Ask the team to replace every labelled example contact with your real oncology and out-of-hours details; ask for a new printed plan when treatment changes.

Sources: NCCP 00551 v7a: current regimen source. Draft source reconciliation; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.